VILLAGER SEAT BELT BUCKLE INSPECTION AND REPLACEMENT

AFFECTED VEHICLES: CERTAIN 2001 MODEL YEAR VILLAGER

OVERVIEW

Certain Villager vehicles may have improperly assembled front row seat belt buckle assemblies. This procedure will provide the detail to correctly identify an affected seat belt buckle, and refer you to the appropriate Workshop Manual section if replacement is necessary.

INSPECTION AND REPLACEMENT

NOTE: THE INSPECTION MUST BE PERFORMED ON BOTH THE DRIVER AND PASSENGER SIDE FRONT ROW SEAT BELT BUCKLES.

1. Grasp the end of the seat belt buckle and rotate the buckle assembly forward and backward as shown in the illustration. The buckle assembly should rotate freely and the plastic anchor boot should remain straight. See Figure 1.
   - If the effort necessary to rotate the buckle assembly bends the plastic anchor boot, replace the buckle assembly. Any bending of the plastic anchor boot is **NOT** acceptable. Refer to the service procedures in Section 501-20A of the appropriate Workshop Manual.
   - If the buckle assembly rotates freely and the plastic anchor boot does not bend, continue with the inspection procedure.

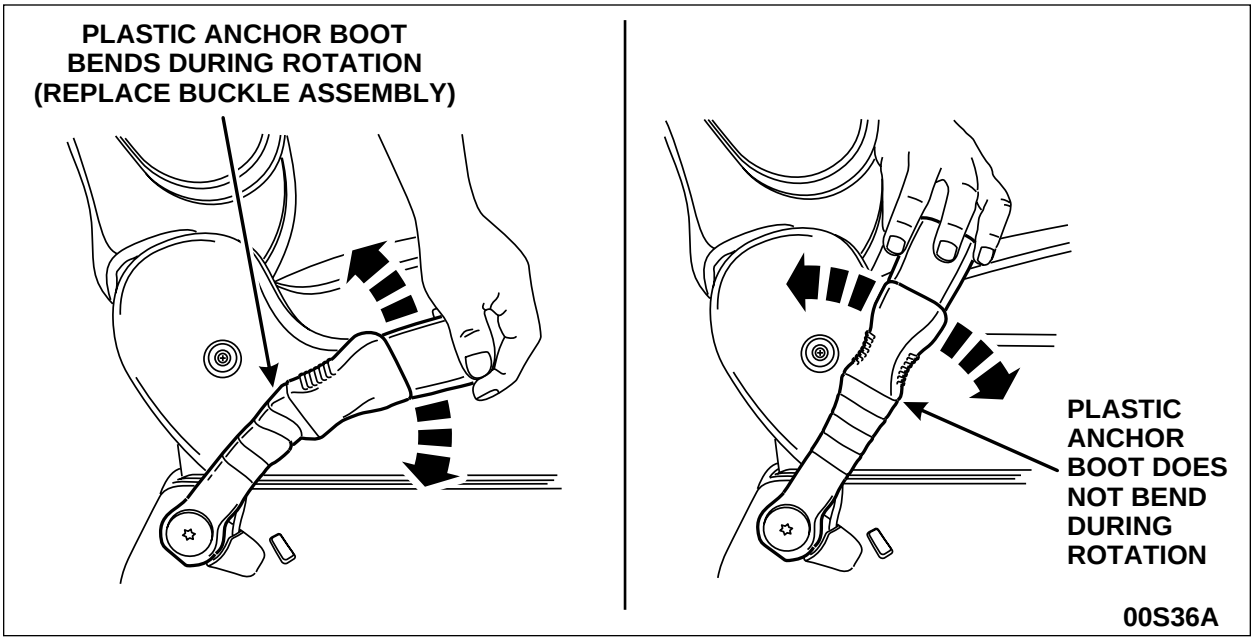

FIGURE 1

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2. Remove the center console, if equipped. Refer to the service procedures in Section 501-12 of the appropriate Workshop Manual.
3. Remove the seat belt buckle bolt cover, then check the torque of the bolt.
   A. If the torque is a minimum of 40 Nm (30 ft-lb), install the seat belt buckle bolt cover. Install the center console, if equipped. No further repair is required.
   B. If the torque of the seat belt bolt is less than 40 Nm (30 ft-lb), tighten the bolt to 40 Nm (30 ft-lb). Grasp the end of the seat belt buckle and rotate the buckle assembly forward and backward.
      - If the effort necessary to rotate the buckle assembly bends the plastic anchor boot, replace the buckle assembly. Any bending of the plastic anchor boot is **NOT** acceptable. Refer to the service procedures in Section 501-20A of the appropriate Workshop Manual.
      - If the buckle assembly rotates freely and the plastic anchor boot does not bend, install the seat belt buckle bolt cover. Install the center console, if equipped. No further repair is required.

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